EXT. A RANDOM NEIGHBORHOOD STREET - APRIL 7TH - DAY

It is a bright, sunny day.

A kid wearing a red raincoat rides down the neighborhood street.

Two women walk along the sidewalk, talking.

Their expressions go blank.

They watch the red coat pass.

The red coat turns at the end of the street.

The women go back to their conversation like nothing happened.

The red coat rides further down the street.

They stop abruptly at a mailbox.

The bike stays steady.

They reach into their pocket and pull out a black envelope. Matte black. No stamp. No return label.

They slide it into the mailbox.

They pedal once.

They ride away.

At the end of the street, they turn.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. LILY'S HOUSE - APRIL 7TH - LATER

A Grey mini van pulls into the driveway.

A woman gets out and unbuckles her daughter and grabs the groceries by the little girls feet.

LUZ
Honey go check the mail while I put the groceries up.

AMY
Okay mommy!

The little girls hops out the car and sprints frame right.

The mother closes the mini van door and walks frame left.

EXT. THE MAILBOX - CONTINUOUS

Little hands reach into the mail box and she pulls out the letter.

Amy looks at it with a curious expression.

AMY
huh?

LUZ (O.S.)
Amy?

Amy looks up and closes the mailbox door.

AMY
Coming!

Amy runs off frame.

AMY (O.S.)
Mommy-mommy look at this!

INT. LILLY'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The mom is organizing the kitchen when her daughter runs in with the envelope.

AMY
Look at this letter!

The mom takes it.

LUZ
Oh? Let me see.

Luz looks at the black envelope.

Her face drops to fear. She takes the envelope with shaking hands.

She puts on a smile for her daughter.

The mom opens it and reads:

HORIZON LOGISTICS

Community Assurance Notice

Dear Resident of Hollow Creek,

As part of our ongoing commitment to maintaining a stable and well-supported community environment, your household has been selected for a routine evening visit.

A Horizon representative will arrive tonight to conduct a standard in-home observation.

There is no cause for concern.

To ensure a smooth visit, please review the following guidelines:

Please ensure your front door is unlocked between the hours of 7:00 PM and 9:00 PM.

Continue your evening as normal. Regular activities (dinner, television, reading, etc.) are encouraged.

Do not prepare or alter your home for the visit. Authentic conditions are appreciated.

All members of the household should remain present and visible.

Regarding children:

Children should not engage with the representative.

Children should not address or acknowledge her presence.

Children should continue their normal routines without interruption.

The representative may move freely throughout your home and may speak aloud as part of her process. This is normal and does not require a response.

Please do not interfere with or interrupt the visit.

A follow-up call will be made shortly after the visit to confirm that all expectations were met.

If you have any concerns following your scheduled visit, please contact Town Hall during regular hours.

Thank you for your continued cooperation.

Horizon Logistics

Community Assurance Division

A single tear rolls down the face of Luz.

AMY
(tilting her head)
What is wrong mommy?

Luz wipes the tear away.

LUZ
Nothing baby.
Um, go get your brother.

INT. LILLY'S LIVING-ROOM- LATER

Luz, Amy, and Ben sit cross-legged around a puzzle box.

LUZ
Okay. Guys, remember the rules? The lady is gonna walk in, walk around and check the house.

Amy nods slowly, clutching a teddy bear.

AMY
But why can't we look at her?

The little boy slaps her arm.

LITTLE BOY
Because mom said so!

LUZ
(frustrated)
That's enough! Ben, don't hit your sister!

She opens the puzzle and spreads it out.

LUZ (cont'd)
Okay kids. We are gonna sit here and do the puzzle. No matter what the lady says or does.
(MORE)

LUZ (cont'd)
We do not talk to her, we DO NOT look at her. DON'T even think about her. She will leave after she is done.

AMY
Done what?

Luz forces a small smile.

LUZ
Whatever she needs to-

Headlights wash across the windows.

Luz freezes.

LUZ (cont'd)
Ben! Go unlock the door and come right back. Don't look.

Ben gets up and runs to the door. He unlocks it, hesitates—

He glances out the small window.

A bright red Mini Cooper idles in the driveway. Headlights shut off.

LUZ (cont'd)
Ben! Don't look!

Ben flinches, runs back, drops to his spot on the carpet.

Luz exhales, trying to steady herself.

LUZ (cont'd)
Okay, just do the puzzle.

The door slowly creaks open.

The three of them keep their eyes down, sorting pieces.

Footsteps enter.

They move through the house, then up the stairs.

No one looks up.

The puzzle pieces click softly against each other.

Footsteps heavy on the floorboards above.

The ceiling groans under her weight.

A drawer opens upstairs.

BANG.

Amy tries to fit two pieces together.

They don't fit.

She keeps trying.

Ben drops a piece in.

Wrong.

He leaves it.

Footsteps come back.

On the stairs now.

Amy's eyes start to lift.

Luz puts a hand over hers.

AMY
(whisper)
Mom—

LUZ
No.

The footsteps reach the bottom.

They stop.

No one moves.

She walks past them.

Into the kitchen.

A cabinet opens.

BANG.

Something sets on the counter.

The fridge hum cuts for a second.

Comes back.

Luz keeps looking down.

LUZ (cont'd)
(quiet)
Keep going.

Amy nods. Doesn’t move.

Ben’s breathing gets louder.

He tries to stop it.

Footsteps again.

Coming back.

She walks into the living room.

Stops behind them.

No one looks.

Nothing happens.

Amy squeezes her teddy bear.

Ben’s hand shakes over a piece.

He presses it down too hard.

It bends.

A breath.

Right behind Amy.

Close.

Amy freezes.

LUZ (cont’d)
(under her breath)
Don’t.

Another breath.

Ben swallows.

His eyes flick up.

Just for a second.

He sees her.

He looks back down fast.

No one says anything.

Then she moves.

Steps away.

Toward the door.

The door opens.

Air moves through the room.

It closes.

Silence.

No one moves.

LUZ (cont'd)
(soft)
It's done.

Ben doesn't touch the puzzle.

Amy breathes again.

They sit there.

Like nothing happened.

LUZ (cont'd)
Go to your room. Clean it up, she probably made a mess. I will work on dinner. Then it's bath-time.

The kids stand up.

BEN
(chin down)
Yes ma'am.

Ben runs out.

AMY
Mommy I need a hug.

Amy wraps her arms around her mother before she too runs away.

LUZ
I love you honey. Go get ready for dinner.

Luz rubs her face and tries to get her breathing under control.

She cleans up the puzzle.

phone RINGS in the kitchen.

Luz takes a deep breath and gets up.

INT. LILLY'S KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

Luz walks up to the ringing phone and answers it.

Static.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.)
Good evening. This is Horizon Logistics calling to complete your household visit report.

Luz doesn't respond and sighs.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.) (cont'd)
We appreciate your cooperation.

Luz rolls her eyes at the sound of the recording.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.) (cont'd)
We are sorry.

Luz eyes widen, she perks up.

LUZ
(confused)
What?

Luz presses the speaker into her ear.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.)
Your household did not meet observational continuity standards.

Luz shakes her head slightly, with a smile. like she didn't hear it right.

LUZ
(denial)
…No.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.)
As a result, your residence has been marked for reassignment.

She shakes her head harder. Her smile grows as her eyes sink.

LUZ
(tearing up, defensive)
That's not—
Who the fuck signed off?

static.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.)
There is no cause for concern.

Luz screams into the phone.

Her voice cracks on the second try.

LUZ
(tears flowing)
NO! Who signed it?!

Silence.

She puts it back up to her ear for the answer.

HORIZON LOGISTICS (V.O.)
Thank you for your participation.

CLICK.

The line goes dead.

Her breath breaks.

LUZ
(numb)
No…

She pulls it away from her ear like it burns.

Then she screams, small at first, like it's stuck in her throat.

LUZ (cont'd)
(helplessness)
No, nooo!

She SLAMS the receiver down.

Hard.

It cracks against the counter.

She grabs it again and throws it into the wall.

Plastic breaks apart.

LUZ (cont'd)
(fear)
Fuck!!!

She can't stop now.

LUZ (cont'd)
Fuck this shit!

She knocks things off the counter.

It hits the floor and breaks.

She slides down the wall.

Sits on the floor.

Hands shaking.

LUZ (cont'd)
(crying)
No… no, no, no…

A long beat.

LUZ (cont'd)
Fuck you…

She breaks.

LUZ (cont'd)
Fuck the company…

She folds in on herself, shaking.

Smash to black.